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Selling Without Selling

Jorge Chavez on trust, the status quo, and helping people buy

Host: Jeremy Rivera · Guest: Jorge Chavez, Topaz Sales Consulting

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WHAT'S INSIDE

Trust-first selling, in seven ideas

A NOTE FROM JEREMY

Jeremy here. I've handed sales teams plenty of leads that didn't close, so Jorge Chavez's take hit home. This little book distills our conversation into the ideas I keep thinking about.

- 01 The philosophy: help people buy
- 02 AI can prep you, not have the conversation
- 03 You don't have to ask for the order
- 04 Empathetic listening and why you have to care
- 05 Detach from the outcome
- 06 Marketing vs. sales — and closing the gap
- 07 More leads isn't more sales

CHAPTER 01

The philosophy: help people buy

Jorge Chavez has spent his entire career in sales, and he arrived somewhere counterintuitive: the goal can't be to sell. At Topaz Sales Consulting he trains people to be buyer facilitators — to help people buy rather than to sell to them.

That reframe changes everything downstream. When selling isn't the goal, you can ask every question under the sun, stay curious, and seek the truth of the situation instead of chasing a yes.

CHAPTER 02

AI can prep you, not have the conversation

Jorge uses AI to research prospects and prepare questions. But he's clear about the limit: someone still has to execute. AI can't read tone, listen in real time, or build the next question on the fly when a prospect dodges or rambles.

“You have to be present, you have to listen, and you have to develop questions on the fly. That's the human interaction that's not available through machines today.”

— Jorge Chavez

That live, human read — being present enough to hear what wasn't said — is still where trust is won.

CHAPTER 03

You don't have to ask for the order

Most sales training insists a competent salesperson has to ask for the order. Jorge flips it: asking assumes the buyer is ready. Instead, assess their readiness and timeline, and ask his favorite question — what happens if you do nothing?

“The biggest competitor for everyone is the status quo. Done properly, buyers ask to buy.”

— Jorge Chavez

Because the real competitor is rarely a named rival. It's no change — the status quo — and it wins more deals than any competitor on your battlecard.

CHAPTER 04

Empathetic listening and why you have to care

Above active listening, Jorge puts empathetic listening: suspending your own biases, training, and experiences to see the situation from the buyer's perspective. Pair it with genuine care and what he calls infinite curiosity — running out of time before you run out of questions.

“If you don't care about people, sales, and relationships, you're in the wrong business.”

— Jorge Chavez

It's harder than it sounds, because it means resisting the reflex to say, 'well, if it were me, I'd do this.' It isn't you. It's them.

CHAPTER 05

Detach from the outcome

The reason people distrust salespeople, Jorge says, is the show-up-and-throw-up, pressure-to-get-a-yes routine. The people running it have a goal in mind — sell something to make money — and, ironically, that goal makes them sell less.

“The goal can't be to sell. It's a byproduct of right thinking and effectively executing your process.”

— Jorge Chavez

His fix is to become a trusted advisor who helps people make informed decisions, even if the answer is that they solve it without you. Detach from the outcome; seek the truth, not a yes.

CHAPTER 06

Marketing vs. sales — and closing the gap

Having trained over a hundred CMOs, Jorge frames marketing and sales as 180 degrees apart. Marketing is many-to-many: it makes assumptions and plays the shiny object to pique curiosity. Sales makes no assumptions and asks questions.

The bridge modern marketers found is to borrow the sales move — ask a pain-tied question ('do you feel your website is reaching the right market?') to shift from macro brand to personal engagement.

CHAPTER 07

More leads isn't more sales

The hard truth for marketers is the one every SEO should hear: more leads isn't more sales. A 300%-leads month can still be your worst month if the leads can't buy.

Close the loop between the two teams, feed real sales-call pain points back into first-person content, and market to the problem people are actually trying to solve.

IDEAS WORTH STEALING

Six to take with you

- 01** Your real competitor is the status quo — find a compelling reason to change before you propose anything.
- 02** Don't ask for the order; assess readiness and let buyers ask to buy.
- 03** Listen empathetically — suspend your biases and borrow the buyer's perspective.
- 04** Detach from the outcome; selling is a byproduct of the right process, not the goal.
- 05** Authenticity is alignment of belief, tonality, body language, and words.
- 06** More leads isn't more sales — close the sales-marketing loop.

GO DEEPER

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